



Removing Delivery Bottlenecks

Week 7 • Day 5 • DP ships today

TPM Academy



Day 5 Objectives

- Convert top 3 queues into **3 experiments** with hypothesis / test / success criterion
- Apply the **Theory of Constraints**: one bottleneck at a time
- Run the **integration pass** across Delivery Plan (DP) Sections 1–5
- Cross-review + sign off the DP — the 5th sibling artifact
- Receive the **Holocron capstone brief**



Today's Shape

Clock	Block	Outcome
09:00 – 09:15	Opening	Pin DP Sections 1–4
09:15 – 10:30	Block 1 + Activity 1	Design 3 experiments
10:45 – 12:00	Block 2 + Activity 2	DP integration pass
13:00 – 14:15	Block 3 + Activity 3	Cross-review with rubric
14:30 – 16:00	Block 4 + Activity 4 + Wrap	Sign-off + Holocron brief

Block 1 — Theory of Constraints

One bottleneck at a time



Goldratt's Claim

A system's throughput is constrained by **exactly one bottleneck at a time**. Not many. One. Optimize anything else and you don't speed up the system — you add inventory in front of the constraint.

Software example: if your slowest step is "code review takes 2 days," speeding up coding doesn't help — it creates more code waiting for review.

Find the bottleneck. Move it. Then find the next one.



Experiment Structure

```
### Experiment N: <name>
**Bottleneck addressed:** <queue>

**Hypothesis:** We believe that <X> will <result>
because <reasoning>.

**Test:** <what / how long / what scope>

**Success criterion:**
- Baseline: <current>
- Target: <improved>
- Window: <duration>

**What could go wrong:** 2-3 risks
**Who runs it:** named person
**By when:** date

**Decision after:**
- Met: adopt / scale / institutionalize
- Not met: abandon / iterate / escalate
```

"We'll see if it feels better" is not an experiment.

Activity 1 — Design 3 Experiments

Quads • 45 minutes

- 5 min: re-read top 3 queues
- 25 min: draft 3 experiments (template)
- 5 min: would your team actually try these in 60 days?



5 + 25 + 5

Block 2 — DP Integration Pass

Sections 1–5 reads coherently top to bottom



The Integration Checklist

The integration pass verifies Sections 1–5 cohere, including the value stream mapping (VSM).

Check	Pass criterion
Section 1 outcomes ↔ Section 2 backlog	Every output in Section 2 maps to an outcome in Section 1
Section 2 backlog ↔ Section 3 tracking	Every leading indicator corresponds to backlog
Section 3 tracking ↔ Section 4 VSM	Cycle-time leading indicators consistent with VSM
Section 4 queues ↔ Section 5 experiments	Every top queue has an experiment
References to PRD/TCD/TMD/SEP	DP cites prior artifacts by section
No fortune-cookie prose	Specific to this feature

Activity 2 — Integration Pass

Quads • 50 minutes

- 15 min: solo read-through
- 10 min: pool issues
- 15 min: fix in priority order (coherence first)



15 + 10 + 15

Block 3 — Cross-Review

The Friday DP Rubric



The DP Rubric

Dimension	Weight
Outcome clarity	20%
ADO discipline	15%
Output ↔ outcome pairing	20%
Value stream realism	20%
Bottleneck experiments	15%
Integration with prior artifacts	10%

Score thresholds: ≥ 3.0 ships. 2.0–2.9 with named gaps. $< 2.0 \rightarrow$ facilitator review.

Activity 3 — Cross-Review

Quad pairs • 50 minutes

- 5 min: pair set-up
- 20 min: cross-read with rubric
- 10 min: author quad responds
- 5 min: capture final score



5 + 20 + 10 + 5

Block 4 — Sign-Off + Week-8 Bridge

The 5-artifact set ships; Holocron brief issued



What Carries to Week 8

Carries forward

- Artifact templates — Product Requirements Document (PRD), Technical Concept Document (TCD), Technical Modeling Document (TMD), Stakeholder Engagement Plan (SEP), DP — in shorter form
- AI provenance discipline
- Negotiation / outcome / tracking muscles
- Cumulative AI-validation log

New in Week 8

- **AI Spec Development** — using AI to draft technical specs that integrate the artifact set
- The Holocron problem brief
- Final artifact presentations



Read the Holocron Brief

Every quad gets the same problem. Read it Friday; do not start solving.

- The **problem in one sentence**, in your own words
- Who you think the **primary user** is
- **Clear problem** you can state in one sentence
- **Public-discussable** (no non-disclosure agreement (NDA) conflicts)

Activity 4 — Sign-Off + Holocron Brief

Quads • 55 minutes • Wrap

- 10 min: adopt / defer / reject reviewer findings; sign off
- 15 min: read the Holocron brief — problem, primary user, first questions
- 10 min: pre-flight (inputs needed; people to ask)
- 5 min: declare preferred candidate



10 + 15 + 10 + 5 • 15-min wrap



Week 7 Wrap

What we shipped this week

- Outcome map (DP Section 1)
- Loaded Azure DevOps (ADO) backlog (Section 2)
- Tracking plan (Section 3)
- Value stream map (Section 4)
- Bottleneck experiments (Section 5)
- Integrated DP — 5th sibling artifact

What opens Week 8

- **AI Spec Development & Capstone**
- Holocron problem brief
- AI Spec dev integrated with artifact set
- Final artifact presentations Friday

Bring to Monday: All 5 sibling artifacts (PRD/TCD/TMD/SEP/DP) + your one-sentence read of the Holocron problem.

Questions & Reflection

Which bottleneck have you been living with that you no longer accept?